> quite skewed analysis to translate limited economic prospects into the reason to join militant groups. However, according to the theory of rapid modernisation, inequality theory, inequality under economic conditions tends to increase the potential for ideological terrorism.[7]

The International Crisis Group (ICG) issued a report in 2002 stating that 'about a third of all students in Pakistan were enrolled in madrasahs'; this estimation was grossly over-stated. According to the results of the survey conducted from 1991 to 2001, the students of madrasahs constituted less than 1 per cent of all students enrolled in Pakistan (Fair, 2009). Moreover, Fair (2009), through research, found 'little evidence to support popular assertions that madrassahs are the cradle of militancy'. However, she added that 'small numbers can have large consequences including sectarianism and connections to sectarian violence, the productions of suicide attacks in Pakistan and elsewhere'. Her assessment about the madrasah–sectarianism connection was correct because madrasahs were established on sectarian lines; however, the involvement of madrasah students in suicide bombings could not be ascertained or confirmed.

The phenomenon of the rise of extremism from the madrasahs was closely linked to the issuance of *Fatawa* (religious edicts), which are legal opinions declaring whether a given act under Islam is obligatory, permitted or forbidden, which strengthened the extremist ideology. Bar (2008) examined how fatawa was served as an instrument for religious leaders to justify to believers to engage in acts of jihad. Islamist terrorists testified that fatawa, particularly originating in the Arab world, motivated them to act.

After 2002, General Pervez Musharraf introduced donor-supported madrasah reform.

English, geography and computer science subjects were introduced in the madrasah syllabus. The education ministry was provided more than $70 million in aid to modernise the curriculum in madrasahs. Most of the funds were not utilised due to non-cooperation from the seminaries (*The Express Tribune*, 2012). Attempts were made to register the madrasahs with the government, which was not complied with by most of them. Very few responded just for the sake of funds. These non-serious reforms produced few tangible changes, with Musharraf regime's alliance with the Islamic parties.